City of Saint Paul

Meeting Minutes

City Council

City Hall and Court House
15 West Kellogg Boulevard
Council Chambers - 3rd Floor
651-266-8560

Council President Rebecca Noecker
Vice President HwaJeong Kim
Councilmember Anika Bowie
Councilmember Molly Coleman
Councilmember Cheniqua Johnson
Councilmember Saura Jost
Councilmember Nelsie Yang

Wednesday, March 4, 2026 **3:30 PM** **Council Chambers - 3rd Floor**

Councilmember Johnson will be participating remotely.

ROLL CALL

Meeting started at 3:31 PM

Present 7 - Councilmember Rebecca Noecker, Councilmember Nelsie Yang, Councilmember HwaJeong Kim, Councilmember Anika Bowie, Councilmember Saura Jost, Councilmember Cheniqua Johnson and Councilmember Molly Coleman

CONSENT AGENDA
Items listed under the Consent Agenda will be enacted by one motion with no separate discussion. If discussion on an item is desired, the item will be removed from the Consent Agenda for separate consideration.

Approval of the Consent Agenda

Council President Noecker stated that Item 13 would be taken separately.

Councilmember Yang moved approval.

Consent Agenda adopted as amended

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

1 RES 26-145 Approving the City's cost for Demolition of Vacant, Nuisance and/or Hazardous Structure from the month of September 2025 and setting date of Legislative Hearing for March 31, 2026 and City Council public hearing for May 6, 2026 to consider and levy the assessments against individual properties. (File No. J2602C, Assessment No. 262001)

Adopted

2 RES 26-146 Approving the City's cost for Demolition of Vacant, Nuisance and/or

Hazardous Structure from the month of November 2025 and setting date of Legislative Hearing for March 31, 2026 and City Council public hearing for May 6, 2026 to consider and levy the assessments against individual properties. (File No. J2603C, Assessment No. 262002)

Adopted

3 RES 26-303 Authorizing the City to enter into a master contract with the Minnesota Department of Employment and Economic Development to allow the City to receive and administer state funds for the operation of Right Track.

Adopted

4 RES 26-307 Approving the Collective Bargaining Agreements (January 1, 2026 - December 31, 2028) and Memorandums of Agreement between the City of Saint Paul and AFSCME Council 5, Clerical - Local 2508 and Technical - Local 1842.

Laid over to March 11, 2026

5 RES 26-328 Authorizing the Department of Parks and Recreation to apply for grant funds of $40,000 from Midway Men's Club.

Adopted

6 RES 26-344 Approving Ordinance Permits 20220010212, 20220010214, 20230010216, 20240010217 - 20240010219, 20250010220, 20250010221 for Roadway - Sidewalk Infrastructure installed by Project Paul, LLC (a wholly-owned subsidiary of Ryan Companies US, Inc.) ("Ryan") on the Ford (Highland Bridge) Site, for roadway sidewalks in various locations on Highland Bridge (District 15, Ward 3).

Adopted

7 RES 26-345 Approving the application for change of ownership to the Auto Repair Garage license now held by Dale Transmission Auto Repair LLC d/b/a Dale Transmission Auto Repair (License ID #DSIBLAUTO-00123-2025) for the premises located at 965 Pierce Butler Route.

Adopted

8 RES 26-355 Authorizing the Fire Department to donate rope rescue equipment to the Department of the Air Force 133rd Air Lift Wing.

Adopted

9 RES 26-366 Authorizing the Department of Parks and Recreation to apply for funds, in an amount of up to $50,000, from the Saint Paul Foundation for Right Track, the City's Youth Employment and Training Program for program year 2026.

Adopted

10 RES 26-373 Accepting the gift of airfare, lodging, meals, and other travel expenses from the Austin Fire Department for Deputy Chief Brittney Baker to participate as an assessor for the EMS process.

Adopted

11 RES 26-380 Approving the application for change of ownership of the Liquor Off Sale and Tobacco Shop license now held by B's Liquors LLC d/b/a B's Liquors (License ID #DSIBLLOFS-000473-2025 and #DSIBLTOBAC-000475-2025) for the premises located at 1047 Hudson Rd.

Adopted

12 RES 26-396 Authorizing the City Council to expend up to $450.00 for food and refreshments at a Ward 6 Community Engagement Event in March 2026.

Adopted

FOR DISCUSSION

13 RES 26-365 Electing the officers of the City Council, Housing and Redevelopment Authority, Library Board, and Council committees, and appointing Council Members to the Audit Committee.

Council President Noecker moved approval of Version 2 and gave remarks.

Councilmembers Kim and Yang gave remarks.

Adopted as amended

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

ORDINANCES

An ordinance is a city law enacted by the City Council. It is read at three separate council meetings and becomes effective after passage by the Council and 30 days after publication in the Saint Paul Pioneer Press. Public hearings on ordinances are generally held at the second reading.

Final Adoption

14 Ord 26-9 Adopting the geothermal energy franchise by The Heights Community Energy, Inc.

Councilmember Yang spoke in favor and moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

15 Ord 26-11 Granting authority to the Port Authority to issue and sell bonds in the principal

amount of approximately $6,000,000, and any bonds to refund such bonds, to secure such bonds with a pledge of the full faith, credit and resources of the City (the "City") and to use the proceeds derived from the sale of such bonds to pay the cost and expense necessarily to be incurred by said Port Authority for a portion of the cost of the redevelopment of part of the St. Joseph's hospital site.

Council President Noecker moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

16 Ord 26-12 Amending section 310.01 of the Saint Paul Legislative Code to create new fee categories and associated license fees for Transportation Network Companies.

Councilmember Yang spoke in favor and moved approval.

Councilmember Bowie spoke in favor.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

SUSPENSION ITEM

Ord 26-18 Amending Section 193.04 of the Legislative Code (Title XIX) to temporarily extend the pre-eviction notice period in Section 193.04 from 30-days to 60-days.

Councilmember Kim gave a summary of the ordinance and answered clarifying questions from Councilmembers Bowie and Johnson.

Councilmembers Yang and Coleman spoke in favor.

Laid over to March 11, 2026 for Second Reading

First Reading

17 Ord 26-16 Granting the application of Xcel Energy to rezone property at 325 Commercial St from H1 Residential to I1 Light Industrial and amending Chapter 60 of the Legislative Code pertaining to the Zoning Map.

Stefan Duarte-Breen gave a staff report.

Public hearing continued to March 11, 2026 for Second Reading

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

PUBLIC HEARINGS

Live testimony is limited to two minutes for each person. See below for optional ways to testify.

18 Ord 24-26 Amending Chapters 65 and 66 of the Legislative Code pertaining to drive-through sales and services and walk-up service windows.

Councilmember Jost moved to close the public hearing. Approved 7-0.

Jost spoke in favor and moved approval.

Councilmembers Yang and Noecker spoke in favor.

Bill Dermody, City Planner, answered clarifying questions from Noecker.

Councilmembers Coleman and Bowie spoke in favor.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

19 RES PH 26-25 Accepting grant funds, authorizing execution of a grant agreement (with indemnity obligations and other documents related thereto), and amending the operating budget with respect to the City's sponsorship of a Metropolitan Council TBRA Grant Application for the benefit of Face to Face at 1170 N. Arcade Street (District 5, Ward 6).

Councilmember Yang moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

20 RES PH 26-64 Transmitting the City's support for the Bronze Line Locally Preferred Alternative to the Metropolitan Council and Ramsey County.

Bill Dermody, City Planner, gave an introduction.

Liz Jones from Metro Transit gave a staff report.

Councilmember Yang spoke in favor and moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

21 ABZA 26-2 Considering the appeal of a decision by the Board of Zoning Appeals denying a variance request to convert an existing lit, freestanding sign to a dynamic display sign at 1305 7th Street West.

YaYa Diatta and Kaozouapang Yang from the Department of Safety and Inspections gave a staff report and answered councilmember questions.

Matt Duffy, sign contractor for the applicant, spoke during the public hearing.

Council President Noecker moved to close the public hearing. Approved 7-0.

Noecker moved to grant the appeal and spoke in favor.

Motion of intent is the appeal is granted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

22 PH 26-4 Public hearing on grievances about federal immigration operations.

Councilmember Kim moved to continue the public hearing for one week.

Public hearing continued to March 11, 2026

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

LEGISLATIVE HEARING DISCUSSION ITEM

35 RLH SAO 26-11 Second Making finding on the appealed nuisance abatement ordered for 1079 WESTERN AVENUE NORTH in Council File RLH SAO 25-71.

Nuisance not abated. DSI authorized to abate.

Negil Neely, property owner, appeared in person

Marcia Moermond, Legislative Hearing Officer: This is the 3rd time this case has been before you. The original summary abatement order came before you in December. The first making finding on whether or not the nuisance had been abated was in January, and Council granted an additional extension. For this second making finding, the tires have been abated, the pallets have not been abated as of last week's legislative hearing. Photos of that are on the overhead projector. We discussed a number of options in the hearing, and Ward 5 has as well. My recommendation is to make a

finding that the nuisance is not abated and that the Department of Safety and Inspections (DSI) be authorized to abate.

Councilmember Bowie: There were several items that needed to be removed, if I remember. Is everything else removed?

Moermond: There were 3 recommended deadlines for items in the yard. One was for tires and pallets, one was for items on the front porch. This file is just for the tires and pallets.

Bowie: Will there be other files for the other items?

Moermond: Yes. Different deadlines are recommended for those.

Negil Neely: The pallets have been removed. I don't know when Moermond was creeping around taking pictures, but they're gone.

Council President Noecker: Anything else you would like to add?

Neely: They also said there were items on the porch that they wanted removed. There were speaker boxes that have also been removed. There were some outdoor toys for my granddaughter as well, which I don't think need to be removed.

Councilmember Kim moved to close the public hearing. Approved 7-0.

Kim: I'm glad the work is done. Moermond, what happens if we approve this, send people to abate a nuisance, and a nuisance has already been abated?

Moermond: The Department would still need to confirm that, but a work order won't be issued if there isn't work needing to be done. If the work order is issued and the work is done by that point, they won't need to do any work. Also, I don't go to properties and creep around. Inspectors document conditions from the exterior. That was discussed in the Legislative Hearing.

Kim: Is there a cost for that?

Moermond: There would not be a cost for a work order to abate a nuisance. There would likely still be a fee for excessive consumption of city services because inspectors have had to keep going out there.

Kim: What is that cost?

Moermond: Between $125 and $130. If it goes unpaid and is processed as an assessment, fees are included for a total of $169.

Kim: How can that be paid?

Moermond: A bill is mailed with a 30-day deadline. If that goes unpaid, another letter is sent with a 15-day deadline. If it still goes unpaid it will be processed as an assessment.

Kim: What was the initial deadline, and when did inspectors go out there?

Moermond: The original deadline I recommended was January 21, 2026. Council then

granted to February 20, 2026. I then had a hearing February 24, 2026. The original orders went out on November 12, 2025.

Kim: And inspectors went back out there on the day of the hearing?

Moermond: Yes.

Kim: I move Moermond's recommendation. If the work is done, there won't be a work order, but the excessive consumption fee is not something that I'm willing to waive.

Adopted

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 1 - Councilmember Bowie

27 RLH TA 25-420 Ratifying the Appealed Special Tax Assessment for property at 692 HAMLINE AVENUE NORTH AKA 1339 VAN BUREN AVENUE. (File No. VB2512B, Assessment No. 258835) (Amend and public hearing continued to March 4, 2026)

Marcia Moermond, Legislative Hearing Officer, gave a staff report.

Beth Jackson, property owner, spoke during the public hearing.

Councilmember Coleman moved to close the public hearing. Approved 7-0.

Moermond answered questions from Coleman.

Coleman moved to approve the assessment and make it payable over 5 years.

Adopted as amended (made payable over 5 years)

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

LEGISLATIVE HEARING CONSENT AGENDA

Items listed under the Consent Agenda will receive a combined public hearing and be enacted by one motion with no separate discussion. Items may be removed from the Consent Agenda for a separate public hearing and discussion if desired.

Approval of the Consent Agenda

Councilmember Bowie moved approval.

Legislative Hearing Consent Agenda adopted as amended

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

23 RLH TA 26-21 Ratifying the Appealed Special Tax Assessment for property at 1160 CLARENCE STREET. (File No. J2603B, Assessment No. 268102)

Adopted

24 RLH TA 26-24 Ratifying the Appealed Special Tax Assessment for property at 1728 CONCORDIA AVENUE (1724 CONCORDIA AVENUE). (File No. J2603B, Assessment No. 268102)

Adopted

25 RLH TA 25-430 Deleting the Appealed Special Tax Assessment for property at 384 EARL STREET. (File No. J2513TW1, Assessment No. 258595)

Adopted

26 RLH TA 26-25 Deleting the Appealed Special Tax Assessment for property at 1556 GROTTO STREET NORTH. (File No. J2605B, Assessment No. 268104)

Adopted

28 RLH SAO 26-17 Making finding on the appealed nuisance abatement ordered for 708 HAWTHORNE AVENUE EAST in Council File RLH SAO 26-8.

Adopted

29 RLH TA 26-20 Ratifying the Appealed Special Tax Assessment for property at 1201 JACKSON STREET. (File No. J2603B, Assessment No. 268102)

Adopted

30 RLH SAO 26-19 Making finding on the appealed nuisance abatement ordered for 1377 MINNEHAHA AVENUE EAST in Council File RLH SAO 26-9. (March 3, 2026 Legislative Hearing)

Referred to March 10, 2026 Legislative Hearing

31 RLH TA 26-26 Ratifying the Appealed Special Tax Assessment for property at 1814 PINEHURST AVENUE WEST. (File No. J2603B, Assessment No. 268102)

Adopted

32 RLH TA 26-27 Deleting the Appealed Special Tax Assessment for property at 847 SEVENTH STREET WEST. (File No. J2603B, Assessment No. 268102)

Adopted

33 RLH TA 26-30 Deleting the Appealed Special Tax Assessment for property at 273 (275) SHERBURNE AVENUE. (File No. J2603B, Assessment No. 268102)

Adopted

34 RLH SAO 26-14 Appeal of Susan K. Smith to a Summary Abatement Order at 1496 UPPER

AFTON ROAD.

Adopted

36 RLH CO 26-2 Appeal of Faustin Grant Felmlee to a Correction Notice at 222 WINIFRED STREET EAST.

Adopted

37 RLH AR 26-5 Ratifying the assessment for Securing and/or Emergency Boarding services during July 2025. (File No. J2603B, Assessment No. 268102)

Adopted

38 RLH AR 26-6 Ratifying the assessment for Securing and/or Emergency Boarding services during September 2025. (File No. J2605B, Assessment No. 268104)

Adopted

ADJOURNMENT

Meeting ended at 5:12 PM

City Council meetings are open for in person attendance, but the public may also comment on public hearing items in writing. Any comments and materials submitted by 12:00 pm of the day before the meeting will be attached to the public record and available for review by the City Council. Comments may be submitted as follows:

Written public comment on public hearing items can be submitted to Contact-Council@ci.stpaul.mn.us or CouncilHearing@ci.stpaul.mn.us. Live testimony will be taken in person in the Council Chambers.

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